

Family Guidebook

An outline for our community



A progressive, student-centered English Center

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palmriveracademy.edu.vn

Welcome to Palm River Academy

Dear Families,

We are so glad you've chosen to be part of our learning environment. Whether you're joining us for the first time or returning for another year, thank you for the trust you place in us.

We believe every student deserves a place where they feel safe to be themselves, where curiosity is encouraged, confidence grows, and kindness is part of everyday life. Together with our families, we strive to create a community where students are supported, challenged, and inspired to reach their full potential.

We hope this handbook helps you get to know Palm River Academy and serves as a helpful guide throughout the year. We look forward to learning, growing, and celebrating many wonderful moments with your family.

With gratitude and excitement,



Ms. Xuan
Owner & Founder



Mr. Seth
Head of Academy





Palm River Academy

Our Mission and Vision



Our Mission



At Palm River Academy, we empower students to discover their strengths, pursue their interests, and build essential life skills. We provide a safe, supportive, and inspiring environment where students gain confidence in their learning and self-discovery. Our goal is to develop independent, lifelong learners who engage respectfully and compassionately with their communities—both locally and globally. Above all, we want our students to grow into happy, fulfilled, and valued individuals.



Our Vision



We are committed to continuous growth and innovation in education by attracting exceptional teachers, expanding learning opportunities through diverse academic pathways, and enhancing teaching methods with hands-on, project-based learning that fosters critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving. We continuously refine policies, update resources, and improve facilities to create a safe and enriching learning environment. By strengthening partnerships with parents, we ensure open communication and collaboration that supports student success. Through these initiatives, we provide a high-quality, forward-thinking education that prepares students for success in the 21st century and beyond.



★ Your Role in Our Partnership

Trust the Process

Every student grows in their own way. We ask families to trust our educators, our educational philosophy, and the learning process, knowing that meaningful growth takes time.

Encourage Independence

Independence grows through practice. Encourage your child to take on age-appropriate responsibilities, solve everyday problems, and take ownership of their actions.

Support Wellbeing

Students learn wellbeing by watching the adults in their lives. By modeling kindness, healthy relationships, and respectful communication, we help them develop confidence, empathy, and resilience.

A strong partnership is built on trust, communication, and shared responsibility. By prioritizing regular attendance, supporting Palm River Academy's policies and educational decisions, and working together with mutual respect, we create the best possible learning experience for every student.





Key Policies You Should Know

Communication

Please notify the administration office by 8:00 a.m. if your child will be absent.

For questions or concerns, please contact your child's homeroom teacher first. If additional support is needed, you may contact the head of academy. Please allow up to 3 business days for a response

Health and Safety



If your child has a fever or is feeling unwell, please keep them home and notify admin.

Your vigilance helps reduce the spread of illness and keeps our learning community healthy.

Travel & Notice Periods

Please provide 7 days' notice if you would like learning materials prepared for a planned absence. Please review our policies for meal refunds, transportation refunds, and tuition withdrawals.

Mobile Phones

Students may bring a mobile phone to Palm River Academy; however, it must be checked in at the front desk upon arrival and will be securely stored until dismissal. If you need to contact your child during the day, please contact the administration office.

This guidebook is reviewed regularly and may be updated at any time to reflect the evolving needs of Palm River Academy. The policies outlined in this handbook will guide our decisions and help ensure consistency and fairness across our learning community.





Palm River Academy



Joining us at Palm River

Finding the right learning environment matters. Our admissions process helps us understand each student's unique strengths, interests, and needs before they begin their journey with us.

Enrollment & Screening

Our admissions process begins with an application and enrollment packet.

Prospective students then meet with the Head Teacher, who evaluates each learner's strengths, interests, English proficiency, and any learning or emotional support needs.

Trial Day

All prospective students complete a trial day to experience Palm River Academy and help us ensure the learning environment is the right fit. A maximum of three trial days may be scheduled.

Trial day fees are credited toward tuition upon enrollment.

New Student Admissions Fee

The one-time New Student Admissions Fee supports student onboarding, including administration, evaluations, and initial learning materials, helping every student begin their journey successfully.



Learning & Emotional Support

Palm River Academy offers supplemental learning and emotional support services provided by qualified professionals.

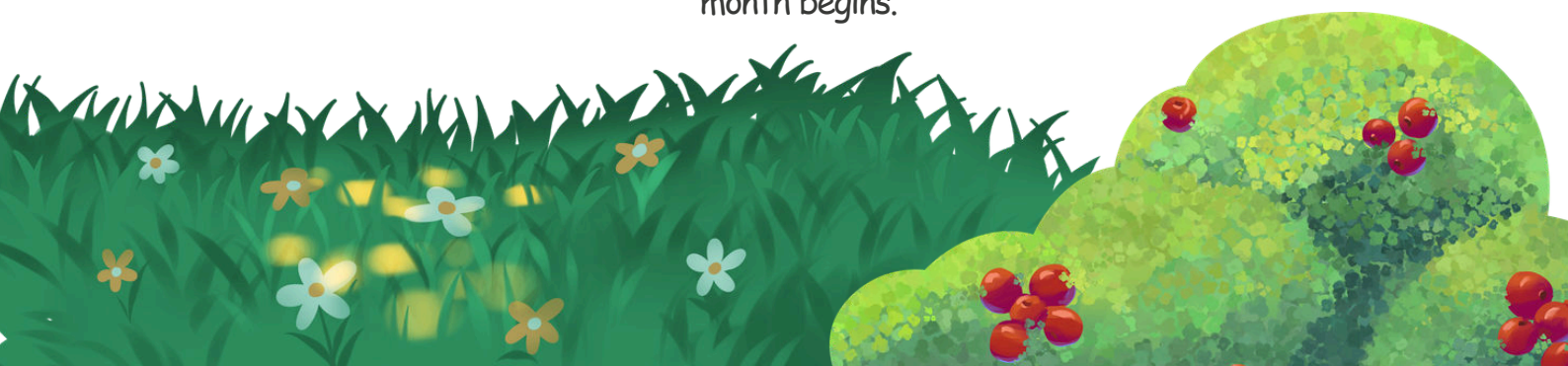
Please contact the administration office for further information. Additional fees may apply.

Tuition & Financial Policies

Families will receive tuition and fee information before enrollment. Please refer to your invoice for payment schedules, refund terms, and withdrawal procedures. Meal plan changes require two weeks' written notice. Transportation is billed monthly and is non-refundable once the month begins.

Getting Started

Before your child's first day, we'll provide everything you need to help your family prepare, including communication information, daily routines, and what to bring.





Palm River Academy

Daily Life at PRA

Every day at Palm River Academy is designed to provide students with a safe, organised, and engaging learning experience. The information below outlines important daily routines and expectations to help each day run smoothly for students, families, and staff.

Attendance, Absences & Travel

Regular attendance supports learning and progress. If your child will be absent, please notify the Admin Office by 8:00AM. If your family is planning to travel, please provide seven days' notice so teachers can prepare learning materials where appropriate.

Arrival & Pick-Up

Students may only be collected by parents or authorised individuals listed on the enrollment form. If pick-up arrangements change, please notify the Admin Office as soon as possible to help ensure a safe dismissal.

Transportation

If your child will not be using the bus or their travel plans change, please notify the Admin Office or the bus driver by 6:00AM on the day of transport.

Food & Snacks

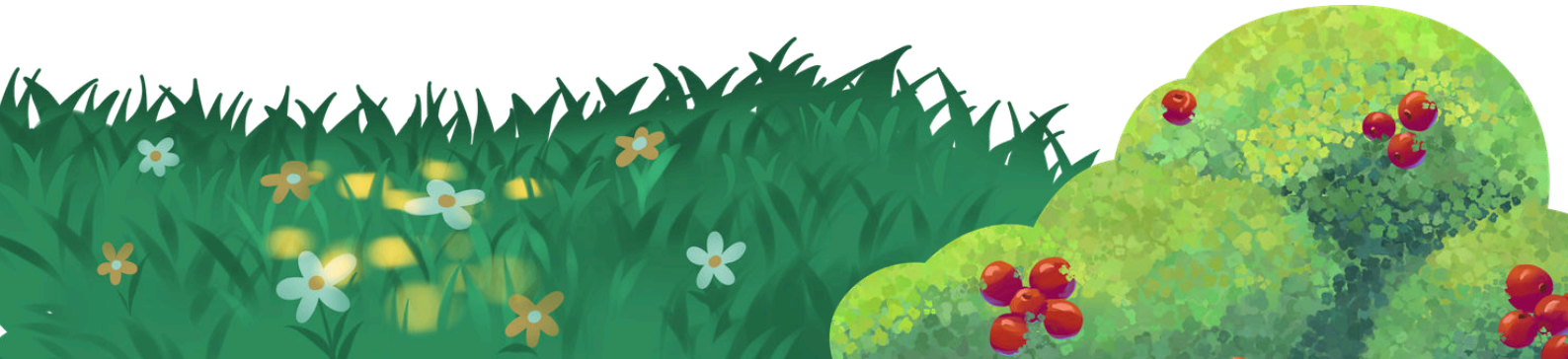
Students on the meal plan receive food throughout the day. Those not on the plan should bring their own meals and snacks. To support student health, food should not be shared. Birthday treats are welcome when provided by the family.

Learning Materials

Palm River Academy provides most everyday learning materials, including notebooks, paper, pencils, and classroom supplies. Families may occasionally be asked to provide items for special activities or personal use.

Early Years Essentials

Please send diapers, wipes, a change of clothes, and a plastic bag each day if needed. Early Years students also enjoy a daily nap or quiet rest period to support their wellbeing.



Learning at PRA



At Palm River Academy, learning extends beyond the classroom. Our programs encourage curiosity, independence, and strong communication skills while supporting each student to grow academically, socially, and emotionally.

Curriculum

Early Years uses a play-based approach built on the Early Years Program (EYP) and phonics. Years 1-9 follow the Cambridge International Curriculum, developing academic knowledge, critical thinking, creativity, and English language skills.

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to complete their work honestly and take pride in their own learning. Teachers guide students in using information responsibly, acknowledging sources, and developing good study habits appropriate for their age.

Extra-Curricular Activities (ECAs)

ECAs run from 3:30-4:15 p.m. on Mondays or Wednesdays. Students may choose one ECA per session. Priority is given to regular program students, with remaining spaces offered to Global Program and Kindergarten students. Prompt pick-up at 4:15 p.m. is required.



Library & Learning Resources



Students have regular access to the library and a variety of learning resources that support reading, research, and independent learning. Families are encouraged to help care for borrowed materials and return them on time.



Student Support

Palm River Academy supports students' academic, social, and emotional development. Counseling and additional support services are available for learning, physical, and mental wellbeing. Some specialised services may be available at an additional cost.

Technology for Learning

Technology is used thoughtfully to support learning while maintaining a balance with traditional teaching methods. Students in Years 1-9 have access to Google Classroom. Palm River Academy provides laptops, and Secondary students may bring their own device with parent permission.





Palm River Academy



Health, Safety & Well-Being

A safe and healthy learning environment allows every student to thrive. The policies below help us care for students, respond appropriately to illness or emergencies, and protect the wellbeing of our learning community.

Health & Safety Guidelines

Students who have a fever or are feeling unwell should remain at home. Please notify the administration office as soon as possible. Keeping sick students at home helps reduce the spread of illness throughout our learning community.

Medication & First Aid

If medication is required during the learning day, it must be given to the First Aid Officer with clear written instructions. Palm River Academy provides basic first aid when needed, and all incidents are documented. Families will be notified whenever first aid is administered.

Medical Conditions & Emergencies

Please inform Palm River Academy of any chronic medical conditions or ongoing health needs. In an emergency, parents will be contacted immediately. If they cannot be reached, Palm River Academy will make appropriate emergency decisions, including transportation to a hospital if required.

Allergies & Dietary Requirements

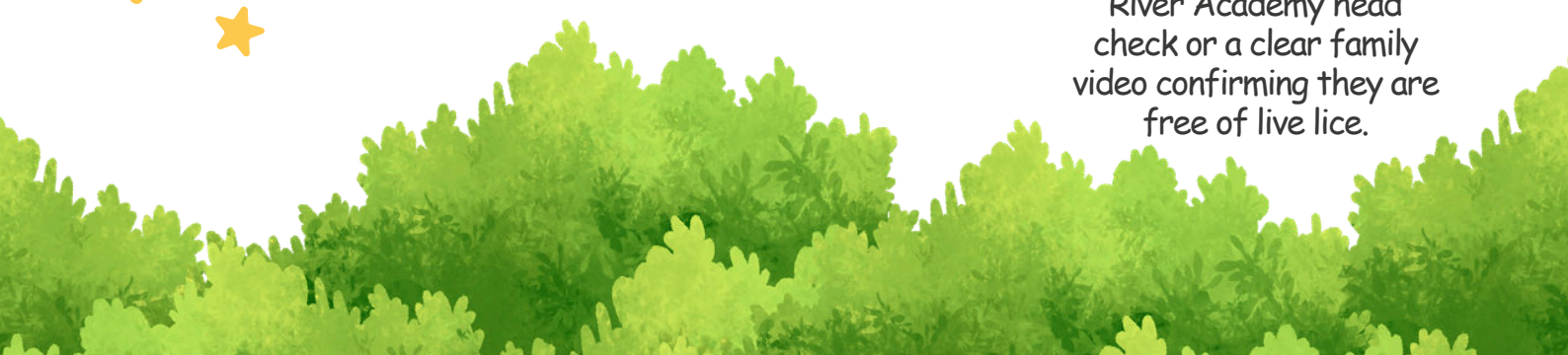
Please notify the administration office of any food allergies or dietary requirements before your child begins. This information helps us provide appropriate meals and maintain a safe learning environment.

Emergency Procedures

Palm River Academy regularly practices emergency drills and maintains procedures for fire, severe weather, and other emergencies. Families will be notified promptly should an emergency occur.

Communicable Illnesses

Students with contagious illnesses, including fever, vomiting, diarrhea, pink eye, or lice, should remain at home until they are no longer contagious. Families should notify the administration office if their child has a communicable illness. For cases of lice, students may return after a Palm River Academy head check or a clear family video confirming they are free of live lice.





Community Expectations

Palm River Academy is built on respect, responsibility, and kindness. These shared expectations help create a safe, welcoming, and inclusive learning environment for everyone.

Respect for Our Community

Students are expected to treat others, learning spaces, and academy property with care and respect. Positive choices and respectful communication help create a welcoming community for all.

Dress Code

Students should wear comfortable, practical clothing with appropriate language and imagery. Closed-toe sports shoes are required for movement and outdoor activities, and hats are encouraged for sun safety.

Mobile Phones & Personal Devices

Students may bring mobile phones, but they must be checked in at the administration office upon arrival and collected at dismissal. Secondary students may bring a personal laptop with parent permission. Mobile phones may only be used to contact parents with educator or administration approval

Technology & Acceptable Use

Technology is a valuable learning tool and should always be used safely, responsibly, and respectfully. Students are expected to follow Palm River Academy's Acceptable Use Guidelines.

Bullying, Cyberbullying & Harassment

Parents are encouraged to speak with their student first and support them in resolving minor conflicts. If concerns continue or involve bullying, cyberbullying, or harassment, please email the Homeroom Teacher or Admin. PRA may investigate incidents outside of PRA hours if they impact the safety or learning environment of our students.

Relationships & Boundaries

Students are expected to maintain respectful and age-appropriate interactions with others. Public displays of affection and behaviour that makes others uncomfortable are not appropriate within the learning environment.





Palm River Academy



Family Partnership

Strong partnerships between families and educators help every student thrive. Open communication, mutual respect, and shared responsibility create the best learning experience for our students.

Working Together

We believe the best outcomes come from working together in good faith, with trust, respect, and open communication. Together, families and educators create a positive and consistent learning experience for every student.

Questions & Concerns

We encourage families to contact the Homeroom Teacher first with questions or concerns about their student. If further assistance is needed, please contact Admin, who will be happy to help.

Quarterly Showcases

Students in Early Years to Year 9 will host a showcase each quarter, sharing work they are most proud of with their families. Parents are invited to celebrate learning and meet with the teacher to discuss their child's progress.



Family Responsibilities

Families play an important role by supporting regular attendance, communicating changes promptly, reinforcing Palm River Academy's expectations at home, and encouraging student independence.

Family Communication

PRA values open communication with families. A weekly newsletter and Family Communication Book will keep families informed. Students in Year 1 and above will use Google Classroom through their PRA Google account, where teachers will share assignments and resources. Academic reports are issued once each quarter.



Contact Information

Please keep your contact information up to date and notify the administration office of any changes. For the quickest communication, we use Zalo and WhatsApp. You can also contact us anytime at admin@palmriveracademy.edu.vn.





Learning is strongest when families and educators work side by side.
Thank you for placing your trust in Palm River Academy. Together,
we'll nurture curiosity, celebrate progress, and support every student
as they grow into capable, caring, and independent young people.

Should you have any questions or need assistance, feel free to reach
out to us.



Contact Information

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